



Republic of the Philippines
Laguna State Polytechnic University
Province of Laguna

COLLEGE OF COMPUTER STUDIES

MIDTERM EXAMINATION IN ITEC 105 – INFORMATION MANAGEMENT

First Semester, A.Y. 2026-2027

Test III – Performance Task – Case Study

InfoMgtSolutions Inc.: Building Knowledge through Information Systems

In today's competitive digital economy, companies rely heavily on **information systems** and **knowledge management (KM)** to sustain growth and innovation. One example is InfoMgtSolutions Inc., a mid-sized IT consulting firm based in Manila. Over a decade, the company expanded rapidly, serving clients in cloud integration, software development, and digital transformation. Yet, with this growth came new challenges in managing information and expertise across its workforce and clients.

Systems Development Struggles

To address these challenges, InfoMgtSolutions invested in developing an integrated information system. The vision was to create a platform where employees could collaborate, share knowledge, and store lessons from past projects. However, the project encountered issues.

During the development phase, the IT department pushed for open-source tools due to flexibility and lower costs, while management preferred commercial solutions with vendor support. This conflict slowed progress. Additionally, unclear requirements led to repeated revisions, project delays, and budget overruns.

This situation reflects **key issues in systems development**: aligning stakeholders, properly defining requirements, and choosing the right technologies.

Intranet and Extranet Solutions

Despite the setbacks, the company launched two platforms:

- An **intranet** for internal use, containing HR policies, project documents, and training materials.
- An **extranet** for clients, enabling them to monitor project progress, provide feedback, and access deliverables.

While promising, the rollout was not without problems. Employees complained that the intranet was hard to navigate, and some resisted using it. Meanwhile, clients expressed concern about whether sensitive data uploaded to the extranet was truly secure.

The Data Security Challenge

Concerns grew after a phishing attack compromised employee emails, giving hackers temporary access to project files. The incident highlighted gaps in InfoMgtSolutions' cybersecurity framework. Were encryption standards adequate? Did employees receive enough training on recognizing phishing attempts? This episode emphasized that **data security** is not merely a technological issue, but also a matter of **human behavior and organizational policy**.

The Knowledge Management Dilemma

Even after deploying the new systems, employees continued to face knowledge-sharing barriers. Senior staff often retained expertise in their heads (**tacit knowledge**), making it inaccessible to others. Teams sometimes "reinvented the wheel," repeating mistakes from earlier projects simply because lessons learned were not properly documented or shared. Meanwhile, younger employees demanded modern, user-friendly platforms similar to social media tools, while older staff resisted adapting to new systems. The company faced the challenge of managing both **explicit knowledge** (documents, reports, manuals) and tacit knowledge (experience, insights, skills).

Critical Success Factors

The leadership at InfoMgtSolutions recognized that technology alone would not guarantee success. What mattered most were **cultural and organizational factors**:

- Strong executive support for knowledge sharing.
- Incentives and recognition for employees who contribute to the knowledge base.
- Clear guidelines on how to store, retrieve, and validate knowledge.
- Building trust so employees feel safe to share ideas.

Without these critical success factors, the new systems risked becoming underused or ignored.

Knowledge Management in Practice

To move forward, InfoMgtSolutions began piloting a **knowledge repository** where project documents and lessons learned could be stored and retrieved. They paired this with **mentorship programs**, allowing senior staff to pass on tacit knowledge. Leadership also explored introducing incentives, such as recognition awards, for active knowledge contributors.

The company realized that **knowledge management is not a one-time project, but an ongoing practice**—one that requires continuous improvement, employee engagement, and a culture of openness.

Discussion Questions:

- 1. Key Issues in Systems Development**
 - What mistakes did InfoMgtSolutions make in developing their new information system?
 - How could they improve requirements gathering and project management?
- 2. Intranet and Extranet**
 - What are the benefits and risks of using intranets and extranets in this company?
 - How can usability and security be balanced?
- 3. Data Security**
 - What specific measures should InfoMgtSolutions implement to protect client data and internal knowledge?
 - How important is employee training in cybersecurity?
- 4. Knowledge Management**
 - What strategies can the company adopt to capture and share both tacit and explicit knowledge?
 - How can resistance to new systems be minimized?
- 5. Challenges and Success Factors**
 - What cultural or organizational changes are necessary for effective knowledge management?
 - Which critical success factors should InfoMgtSolutions prioritize first?
- 6. KM in Practice**
 - Imagine you are a consultant for InfoMgtSolutions. What concrete steps would you recommend to make their knowledge management initiative successful?

Outline / Format

Section	Content
I. Title Page	Case title, student information, course, instructor, date
II. Executive Summary	Brief summary of the entire case
III. Case Background	Organization and information-management situation
IV. Problem Identification	Major problems and issues
V. Case Analysis	Analysis of systems development, intranet/extranet, etc.
VI. Data Security Analysis	Security threats, controls, and human factors
VII. Knowledge Management Analysis	Tacit/explicit knowledge and knowledge sharing
VIII. Challenges & Critical Success Factors	Organizational and cultural considerations
IX. Proposed Solutions/Recommendations	Specific recommendations
X. Implementation Plan	Step-by-step action plan
XI. Expected Outcomes	Expected results
XII. Conclusion	Overall findings and proposed direction
XIII. References	Sources used